

Improvisation for Blues and Rock Guitar



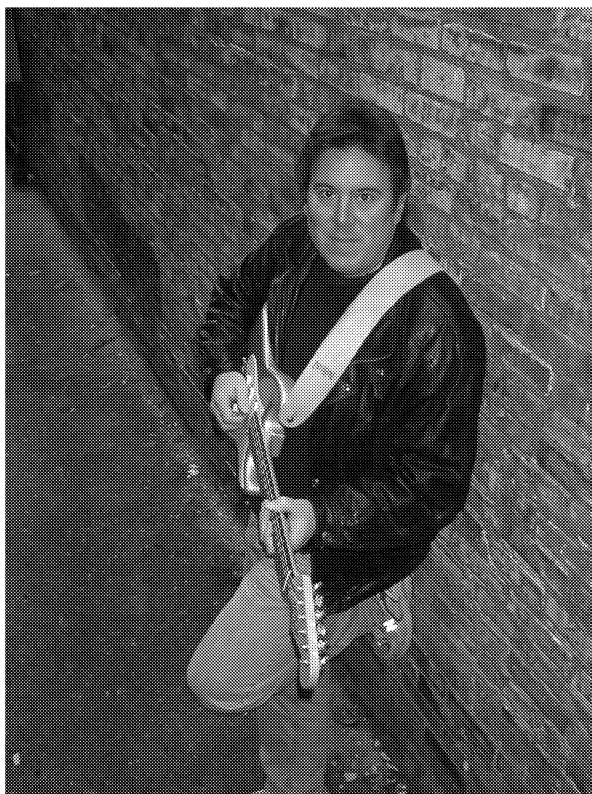
A Fresh New Approach to Lead Guitar
Improvisation for the Blues and Rock Guitar
Enthusiast

By Greg Seaman

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About the Author



Greg Seaman is a guitarist, singer, music instructor and songwriter, currently residing in Traverse City, Michigan, where he teaches private lessons on guitar, bass guitar and singing. Greg performs regularly in restaurants and clubs throughout Northern Michigan. With over 30 years of live performance and teaching experience Greg keeps busy as a full time musician, playing solo with acoustic guitar and in numerous bands, while maintaining a private lesson schedule of over 60 weekly students.

Greg's musical influences are primarily blues and rock guitarist such as Stevie Ray Vaughn, Jimmy Page, Eric Clapton and Jimi Hendrix. With his students he has played and studied almost every music style, including Metal, Classical, Blues, Jazz, Country and Bluegrass.

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Welcome to Improvisation for Blues and Rock Guitar!

The main theme of this book is that if a guitarist can learn the main scale shapes on the guitar, understand how to find the “root tones” on the fret board and learn the basic scale shapes, then the guitarist can move to different modes on the fly when they improvise. It also makes learning mode types and scale shapes that are offered in other books and manuals so much easier to understand.

I have seen great books on lead guitar that have pages and pages of scale shapes for every key and every mode. When I looked at them, I could see where they might be overwhelming and intimidating to guitarist trying to deepen their understanding of soloing with a guitar, and I would think to myself, “you can have all this data in your head, and it’s not that hard to learn”.

I knew from my years of experience as a guitarist that there is a simpler way to learn this information. With my program, a guitarist can have all of those pages and pages of scale shapes, modes and keys at their finger tips, to use on the fly as they improvise in any musical genre.

The system in this book is how I have taught many students the fundamentals of lead guitar soloing over the years. I combine working on the concepts in this book with learning the actual leads of the great guitar virtuosos of our time, Jimi Hendrix, Eric Clapton, Stevie Ray Vaughn and Jimmy Page, just to name a few. It greatly helps with the understanding of how to improvise when a student can actually see and understand how great guitar players use scales and modes to create their leads.

Even though this book leans in the direction of blues and rock guitar soloing, the concepts work in any musical genre. I have included backing tracks that are Jazz, Latin and acoustic oriented to bring this point home.

The music theory and playing techniques that I have outlined in this book are fundamental concepts that every serious guitarist should know. With a good understanding of these concepts, guitarist will greatly increase what they can do when playing solos and greatly enhance their enjoyment of guitar playing.

Thanks for buying this book and enjoy the benefits it will give you!

The Pentatonic Scales

The pentatonic scale is the workhorse of lead guitar improvisation. Pentatonic scales have five notes. The two most popular pentatonic scales are the Minor Pentatonic and the Major Pentatonic. Fig.1 shows the notes that make up the minor and major pentatonic scales.

Fig.1

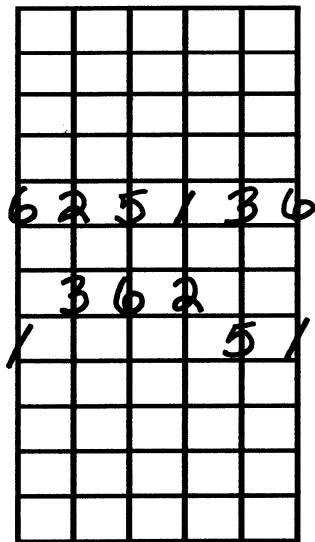
Major Pentatonic



Minor Pentatonic



Major Pentatonic



Minor Pentatonic

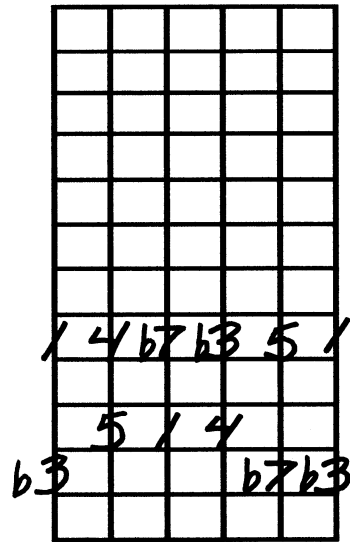


Fig. 2 & Fig. 3 shows the above pentatonic shape with the three-octave shape next to it in its relative position, along with a diagram of the scale tone locations. These are two of the most popular pentatonic shapes for lead guitar.

Fig. 2

G Minor Pentatonic Shape #2 with Three Octave Pentatonic Shape

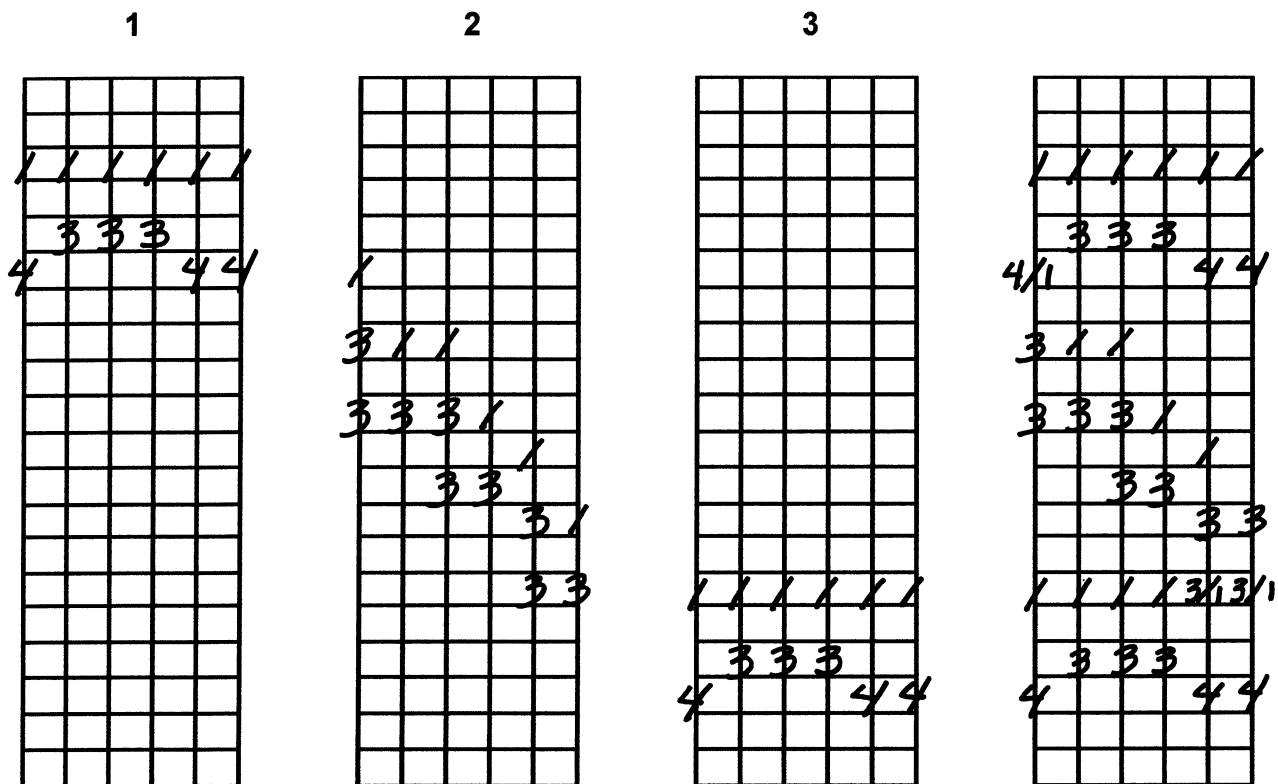
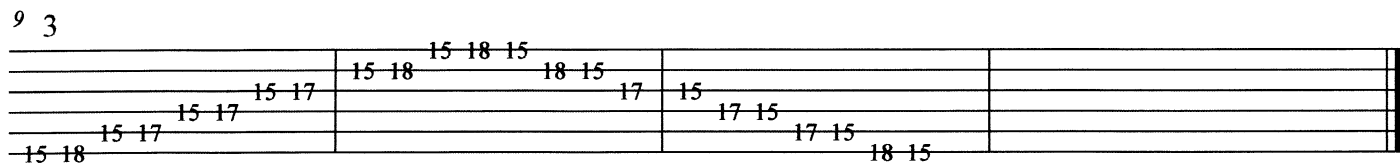
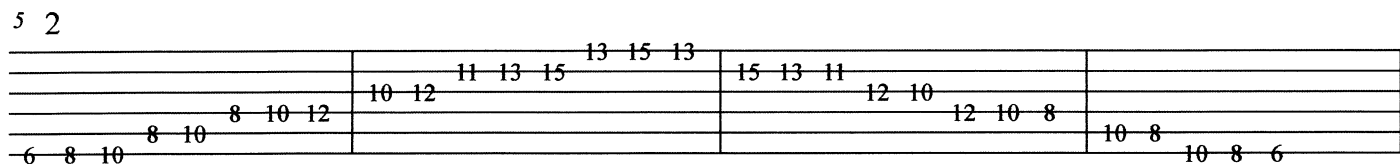
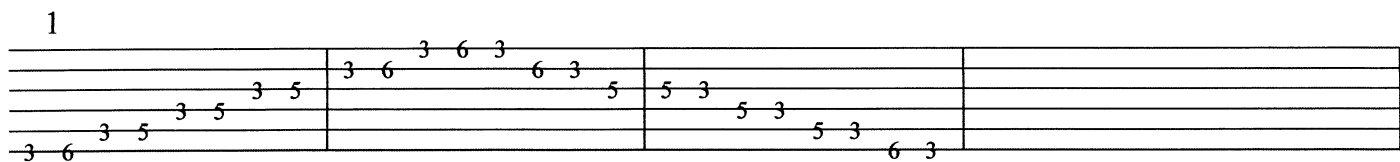


Fig. 3

G Minor Pentatonic Showing Scale Degrees and Notation

1 b3 4 5 b7

G Bb C D F G Bb C D F G Bb

b3 4 5 b7 1

Bb C D F G Bb C D F G Bb C D F G

Fingering

Scale Degrees

We will use the pentatonic shapes from **Fig. 2 & Fig. 3** to play our first licks. The following section contains basic explanation of guitar tablature and a few basic guitar moves, followed by the notation and tablature for sixteen licks.

On CD track number one, I play all the examples on the guitar tablature and basic lead guitar moves page. Please give close attention to the first line that explains how bends work. The bend on guitar is a very expressive technique and should be thoroughly practiced. Notice that each bend starts with a slide that shows what the bended note should sound like. In this way you can “tune” your bend to sound at the same pitch as the note you slide to.

For example, the first slide goes from the 7th fret on the third string to the 9th fret, which is a whole step. When you then bend the note on the 7th fret, it should be at the same pitch as the note on the 9th fret that you slide to.

Practice “tuning “ your bends to the slide note, especially the whole step and half step bends, because they are the most common.

Guitar Tablature & Basic Lead Guitar Moves

Guitar

full	1/2	1 1/2	2
Whole Step Bend	Half Step Bend	1 1/2 Step Bend	2 Step Bend

5 H 7	7 P 5	5 H 7 P 5	5 H 7 P 5
Hammer On	Pull Off	Hammer On - Pull Off	Trill

7 ~ 7	5 / 7	full (7)
Vibrato	Slide	Whole Step Bend & Release

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Basic Moves in "A" Minor Pentatonic

1 full	2 full	3 full	4 full
1	2	3	4

5 full	4 & 5 Combined full
5	4 & 5 Combined

1, 3 & 4 Combined full	full
1, 3 & 4 Combined	Move 5

Sixteen Licks In “A” Minor Pentatonic

This section has the notation and tablature for sixteen licks that primarily uses the minor pentatonic scale in the key of A. The licks are on the CD tracks 2 through 17. I play each lick slowly, then faster, more to the tempo the lick would actually be used for in a song.

Learn to play each lick exactly how I played them on the CD. Try to copy my exact “voicing” for each lick.

The idea behind the licks is to show how the pentatonic shapes can be used. When you play the licks, it is up to your own artistic expression on how the licks should be played, and when. The licks will “prime the pump” and get you on your way to improvising. You actually are improvising when you choose when to play the lick and how the voicing of the lick works.

“Voicing” means how the lick is played, how fast or slow you play it, how long you hold out bends or how quickly you do hammer-ons and pull-offs. You should copy my voicings exactly when you first learn each lick, but don’t be afraid to change it according to your own artistic expression.

On CD track number 18, Am7 Groove, I play each of the sixteen licks again in consecutive order, showing how the licks can be used in a song. Then track number 19 is your opportunity to use the licks along with the same music.

Licks in "A" Minor Pentatonic

Lick #1

Guitar

Guitar

T
A
B

Lick #2

Gtr.

Gtr.

Lick #3

Gtr.

Gtr.

Lick #4

Gtr.

Gtr.

Lick #5

17

Gtr.

Gtr.

3 5 3 5 5/7 5 7 5 7 5 5 8 5 8 5 7 5 7 5 H 6 7

Lick #6

21

Gtr.

Gtr.

4/5 5 5 5 5 5 5 5/8 8 8 8 8 8 8 7 5 H 6 7

Lick #7

25

Gtr.

Gtr.

7/9 8 10 10 8 10 10 8 7 8 7 8 7

Lick #8

29

Gtr.

Gtr.

7/9 8 9 8 7 5 1/2 7 5 H 7 5 7 7 5 H 6 7

Lick #9

Guitar

Guitar

TAB

Lick #10

Gtr.

Gtr.

Lick #11

Gtr.

Gtr.

Lick #12

Gtr.

Gtr.

13

16

[illegible]

19

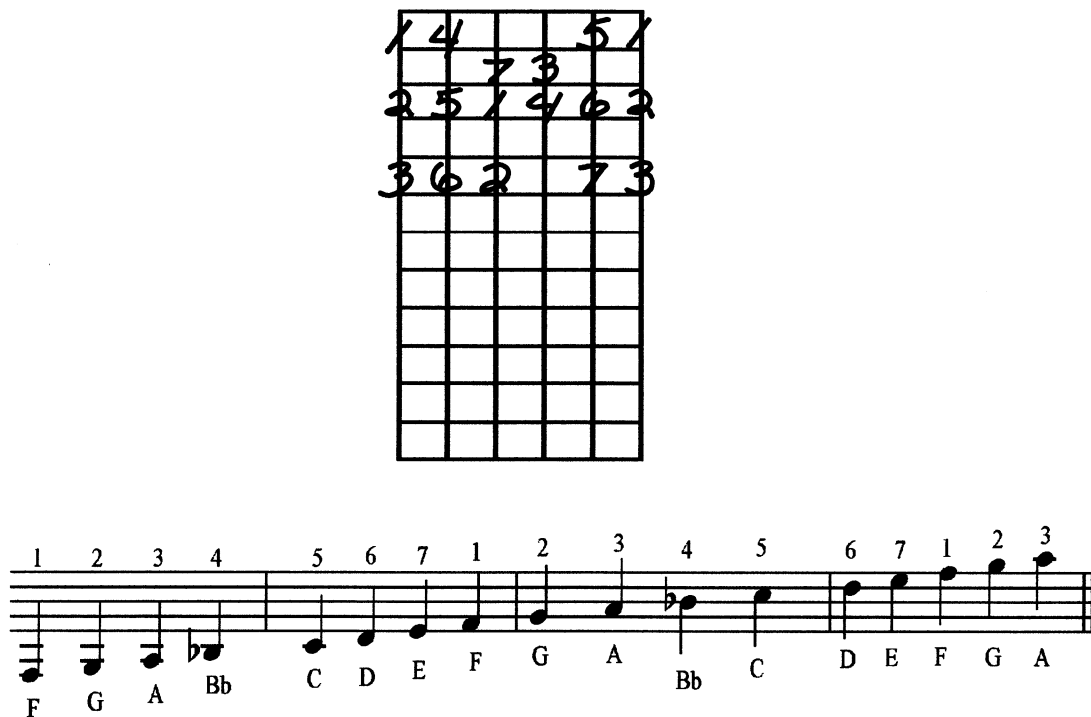
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Learning the Scale Shapes on the Fretboard

An important part of playing lead guitar is learning the scale shapes on the fretboard. We will divide the fretboard into five “shapes” that need to be memorized. Practicing these shapes will have many benefits for your guitar playing. They will help you to synchronize your left hand with your right hand, so that you will be able to find the note with your pick in the right hand that your left hand is fretting on the finger board. If you follow the practice regime that is suggested with these scales, your guitar playing will move to the next level. Everything you do on the guitar will improve, playing chords, playing leads and picking.

Lets look at how the scale diagrams work (**Fig. 4**). The top diagram is the scale with the scale degree numbers in each position. The scale degrees simply mean that the number “1” is the first note of the scale, the number “2” is the second note of the scale, ect. We will be using these numbers to locate the scales in different keys and modes for playing leads.

Fig. 4



The following page is the **Master Scale Form** page. This page is what you will refer to as you memorize the scale shapes and learn to locate them in different keys and modes.

Master Scale Forms

Seven Tone Scale Shapes with Scale Degrees and Fingering

1	2	3	4	5
1 1 4 5 1 2 5 1 4 6 2 3 6 2 7 3	2 5 1 4 6 2 3 6 2 5 7 3 4 7 3 1 4	3 6 2 5 7 3 4 7 3 1 4 5 1 4 2 5	5 1 4 2 5 6 2 5 1 3 6 7 3 6 7	6 2 5 1 3 6 7 3 6 2 7 1 4 7 5 1
1 1 1 1 1 2 2 2 2 2 4 4 4 4 4	3 1 1 1 1 1 1 3 3 3 3 3 3 4 4 4 4 4	5 1 1 1 1 1 1 2 3 3 2 2 4 4 4 4 4	8 1 1 1 1 1 2 2 2 2 2 2 4 4 4 3 4	10 1 1 1 1 1 1 2 3 3 3 3 3 4 4 4 4 4

Five Tone Scale Shapes

1	2	3	4	5
1 1 1 1 1 3 3 3 3 3	3 1 1 1 1 1 3 3 3 4 1 4 4 6 2	1 1 1 1 1 3 3 3 4 4 4 3 3 3	8 1 1 1 1 1 3 3 3 3 3 3	10 1 1 1 1 1 3 3 3 3 3 4 4 3 3 4

FIG. 5 Seven Tone Scale Shapes in Notation and Tablature

Shape 1

Shape 1 is a seven-tone scale in E-flat major. The notation shows a treble clef with a key signature of one flat (B-flat) and a common time signature (C). The scale is written in a single line, starting on the first line (E4) and ending on the first line (E5). The tablature shows the fret numbers for each note: 1, 3, 5, 1, 3, 5, 2, 3, 5, 2, 3, 5, 1, 3, 5, 1, 3, 5. The scale is played in a single line, with the first line (E4) and the second line (F4) being the most common positions.

Shape 2

Shape 2 is a seven-tone scale in E-flat major. The notation shows a treble clef with a key signature of one flat (B-flat) and a common time signature (C). The scale is written in a single line, starting on the first line (E4) and ending on the first line (E5). The tablature shows the fret numbers for each note: 3, 5, 6, 3, 5, 7, 3, 5, 7, 3, 5, 6, 3, 5, 6, 3, 5, 6. The scale is played in a single line, with the first line (E4) and the second line (F4) being the most common positions.

Shape 3

Shape 3 is a seven-tone scale in E-flat major. The notation shows a treble clef with a key signature of one flat (B-flat) and a common time signature (C). The scale is written in a single line, starting on the first line (E4) and ending on the first line (E5). The tablature shows the fret numbers for each note: 5, 6, 8, 5, 7, 8, 5, 7, 8, 5, 7, 8, 5, 6, 8, 5, 6, 8. The scale is played in a single line, with the first line (E4) and the second line (F4) being the most common positions.

Shape 4

Shape 4 is a seven-tone scale in E-flat major. The notation shows a treble clef with a key signature of one flat (B-flat) and a common time signature (C). The scale is written in a single line, starting on the first line (E4) and ending on the first line (E5). The tablature shows the fret numbers for each note: 8, 10, 12, 8, 10, 12, 8, 10, 12, 8, 10, 12, 9, 10, 8, 10, 11, 8, 10, 12. The scale is played in a single line, with the first line (E4) and the second line (F4) being the most common positions.

Shape 5

Shape 5 is a seven-tone scale in E-flat major. The notation shows a treble clef with a key signature of one flat (B-flat) and a common time signature (C). The scale is written in a single line, starting on the first line (E4) and ending on the first line (E5). The tablature shows the fret numbers for each note: 10, 12, 13, 10, 12, 13, 10, 12, 14, 10, 12, 10, 11, 13, 10, 12, 13, 10, 12, 13. The scale is played in a single line, with the first line (E4) and the second line (F4) being the most common positions.

Now let's examine all the shapes on the **Master Scale Form** page. You will notice that each scale cascades down the neck and they dovetail together. The 1st scale starts on the first fret, the 2nd scale starts on the third fret, the 3rd scale starts on the fifth fret, the 4th scale starts on the eighth fret and the 5th scale starts on the tenth fret.

It is important to memorize the scale shapes in consecutive order. They are all using the same 7 notes when played in this sequence, and they use the entire fretboard of the guitar. The last notes of scale number five are the first notes of scale number one, so they loop back around and start over again. When you memorize the scale shapes in this sequence, it will be easier to locate them in different keys and modes when playing leads.

Below the scale shapes with the degree numbers are the exact same scale with suggested fingering. These are the same scale shapes and are played on the same frets as their counterparts above.

Below the scale shape fingerings are the pentatonic scale shapes. Each pentatonic comes from the scale shape above and is played on the frets marked on the diagram. Each pentatonic shape needs to be memorized along with knowing which shape it came from.

Practicing the Scale Shapes

Practicing these scales need to become part of your daily practice regime. There are three ways I would like you to practice these scales.

First, start with scale shape number one and play it at the first fret. Start at the sixth string and play up to the highest note on the first string, then play the scale backwards and come back down, playing the highest note on the first string only once. Set your metronome at a pace that is easy to play with the minimum amount of mistakes. If you are making too many mistakes as you play, your metronome is going too fast, slow it down a little and try again. Play eighth notes as you practice (play two notes for every one click of the metronome). Then move to the second fret and play the scale shape again. Move up one fret at a time each time you play the scale, going up the neck to the 12th fret, then move back down one fret at a time until you come back to where you started from on the first fret. Let the metronome click one beat in between each scale as you end one scale and move to the next fret to start the next. As you practice, increase the speed of the metronome to the fastest speed you can play without making too many mistakes. This will increase your ability to play the scales fast and accurately. Be sure to pick back and forth with your pick. This is very important, alternate picking is much faster than picking straight down. To increase picking speed, you should not touch the guitar with your right hand as you pick. If you do this you will find that you can pick much faster.

Second, practice each scale in consecutive order. Starting with first scale, play each scale in order from lowest to highest. Work through their order both forwards and backwards. This important exercise will help you memorize each scale in order. When you start playing using the first scale in a particular key and mode, you will know where the other four scale shapes fall in order from that starting point. This will start you down the path of using the entire guitar neck when you improvise.

Third, practice the five scale shapes in consecutive order and after you play each shape, play the corresponding pentatonic below. Move back and forth, first playing the 1st scale shape forward and backward, then play the pentatonic that comes from it directly below the same way, forward and backward. Then move to the second seven-tone shape and corresponding pentatonic shape, and then continue on.

Fig. 5 are the seven tone scales, written in notation and guitar tablature. Some students find it easier to read tablature, but it important to be able to “see” the five scale shapes on the fretboard as illustrated on the **Master Scale Form** page.

How the Seven Tone Scale Shapes Work

Now lets discuss how the scale shapes work on the fretboard and how to locate them in different keys and modes.

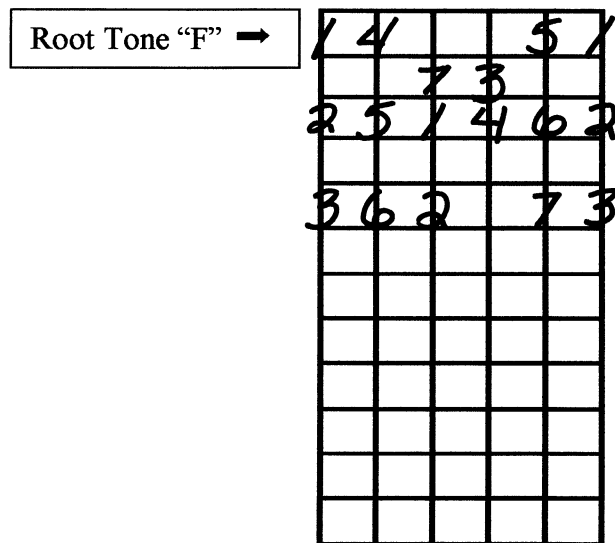
Fig. 6 is the first scale shape. We use the numbers of the scale degrees to locate the shape on the fretboard in the key and mode we want to use. We do that by making the number of the Mode land on the “root tone” of the key we want to play in.

Lets say that we want to play in the key of “F” major and we want to use the Ionian mode. We will make the number “1” in the scale shape land on the “F” note on the fretboard. F is located on the 1st fret of the 6th string. That is now our “root tone”.

Note: The Root Tone is the single note of the same name as the key we wish to play in.

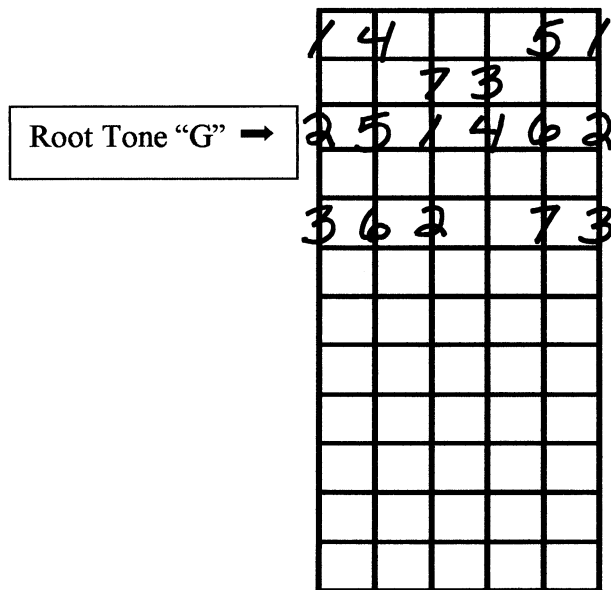
The other scale shapes as well as the Pentatonics will be located in their proper sequence in consecutive order as illustrated on the **Master Chord Shape** page.

Fig. 6



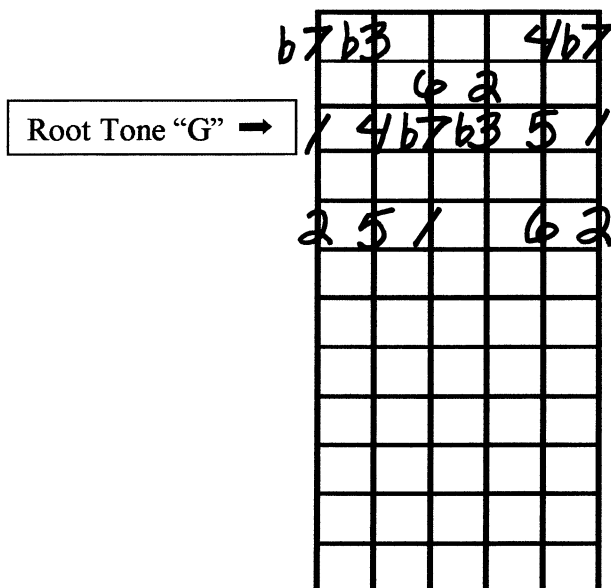
Now lets go back to scale shape number one again and locate it in the Dorian Mode for the key of “G”. G is located on the 3rd fret of the 6th string. In **Fig. 7** the G note becomes our root tone. This is where we will play the scale for G Dorian Mode.

Fig. 7



In actuality, the G note on the 3rd fret now becomes the 1st note of the Dorian Mode scale in the key of G. **Fig. 8** shows how the scale degrees change for the Dorian Mode in the key of G. Look ahead to **Fig. 10** and compare the notes.

Fig. 8



The scale degrees shift "automatically" if you will. You will still play the shape the same way that you learned, but if you are playing the shape on this location on the neck, you will be playing in G Dorian mode.

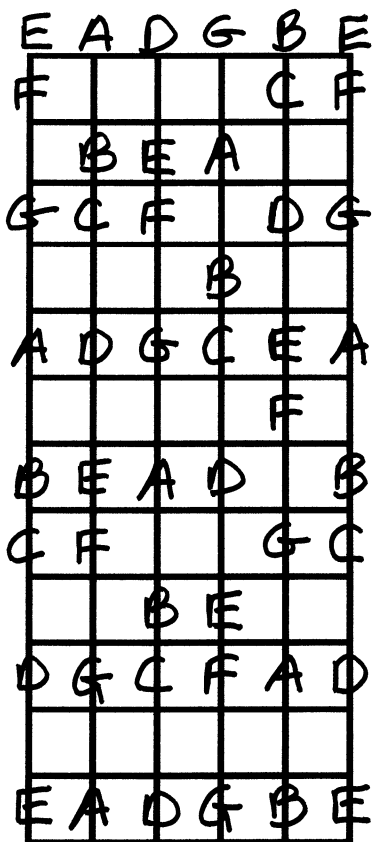
Learning the Notes on the Fretboard

It is important to learn the notes on the fretboard so you can locate scale shapes in different keys and modes. This is easier than you might think and really does not require memorizing the entire fretboard. There are tricks to it that once you learn them, you can rattle off the names of each note on the fretboard without looking at a chart.

In **Fig. 9** all of the notes on the fretboard are named without sharps and flats. On the guitar, a half step is one fret and a whole step is two frets. There are two natural half steps between E-F and B-C, all the other notes are whole steps.

The key thing to remember is that the notes move in alphabetical order up the neck on each string, starting with the name of the string.

Fig. 9



Start on the 6th string playing it open, that is “E”. Then move to the 1st fret on the 6th string, that is “F”, which is a half step. Then play “G” which is 3rd fret on the 6th string and is a whole step from F. Follow this up to the 12th fret. At the 12th fret, everything starts over again. That is the Octave, where we started on an “E” and played all of the notes on that string until we landed on “E” again, on the 12th fret, one Octave higher.

Do the same thing on the other strings, first by following the diagram, and then do it without the diagram. The frets we skip are the sharps and flats. The 2nd fret on the 6th string is F# and Gb. Sharps increase a note by a half step, and flats lower the note by a half step. By moving the F note on the 1st fret of the 6th string to the 2nd fret, we have F#. Moving the G note on the 3rd fret down to the 2nd fret, we have Gb.

Learning The Seven Basic Modes

In **Fig. 10** the seven modes are written out in their relationship to each other. It is important to understand that what makes each mode sound different is its half step and whole step arrangement. In mode number 1, Ionian, which is the Major scale, there are two natural half steps that occur between E-F and B-C. Each mode is built on each of the seven degrees of the major scale. The Dorian mode starts on the second degree of the scale and the first note "D" is added to the end to complete the octave. You can see how the step arrangement shifts to create each mode.

Fig. 10

The Modes

The figure displays the seven modes of music, each on a separate staff. The modes are listed on the left: IONIAN (MAJOR), DORIAN, PHRYGIAN, LYDIAN, MIXOLYDIAN, AEOLIAN (MINOR), and LOCRIAN. Each staff shows a sequence of notes with step intervals indicated by numbers (1 for whole, 1/2 for half) below the notes. The modes are arranged in ascending order of their starting notes: C, D, E, F, G, A, B.

Mode	Step Pattern (Whole = 1, Half = 1/2)
IONIAN (MAJOR)	1 1 1/2 1 1 1 1/2
DORIAN	1 1/2 1 1 1 1/2 1
PHRYGIAN	1/2 1 1 1 1/2 1 1
LYDIAN	1 1 1 1/2 1 1 1/2
MIXOLYDIAN	1 1 1/2 1 1 1/2 1
AEOLIAN (MINOR)	1 1/2 1 1 1/2 1 1
LOCRIAN	1/2 1 1 1/2 1 1 1

Here is another way of looking at the whole step half step arrangements of the modes. In **Fig. 11**, we take the “C” major scale and use the appropriate sharps and flats to create the same whole step half step arrangements for each mode as in **Fig.10** above.

Fig. 11

The figure displays the eight modes of the C major scale, each with its characteristic whole (1) and half (1/2) step intervals. The modes are listed vertically, each on a five-line staff. The intervals are indicated by numbers 1 and 1/2 placed below the notes. The modes are: IONIAN (MAJOR), DORIAN, PHRYGIAN, LYDIAN, MIXOLYDIAN, AEOLIAN (MINOR), and LOCRIAN. The notes are C, D, E, F, G, A, B, and C, with appropriate sharps and flats used to create the correct mode.

Mode	Interval Sequence (Whole/Half Steps)
IONIAN (MAJOR)	1, 1, 1/2, 1, 1, 1, 1/2
DORIAN	1, 1/2, 1, 1, 1, 1/2, 1
PHRYGIAN	1/2, 1, 1, 1, 1/2, 1, 1
LYDIAN	1, 1, 1, 1/2, 1, 1, 1/2
MIXOLYDIAN	1, 1, 1/2, 1, 1, 1/2, 1
AEOLIAN (MINOR)	1, 1/2, 1, 1, 1/2, 1, 1
LOCRIAN	1/2, 1, 1, 1/2, 1, 1, 1

How to Use the Seven Basic Modes

In this section we will discuss each mode in detail and outline what scenarios each mode functions best in. You can refer to this section as you experiment with using the modes along with the jam tracks on the CD.

Mode #1 Ionian: The Ionian mode is also better known as the Major scale. It works well over major sounding chords such as C, Cmaj7, C6 and C6/9. As long as the song uses the diatonic chords of a key (those composed of the scale tones only) you can improvise with the Ionian mode regardless of the chord changes.

Mode #2 Dorian: The Dorian mode works well over the whole family of minor chords, such as Cm, Cm7, Cm6, Cm9, and Cm11. It is one of the most commonly used scales for improvising. Dorian mode is also closely related to the Minor Pentatonic scale. Anywhere that you are playing a scale shape in the Dorian mode, you can use the pentatonic shape that it is related to (the Pentatonic shapes that are directly below the scale shapes in Fig. 2) and you will be playing the Minor Pentatonic of that key.

Mode #3 Phrygian: The Phrygian mode sounds very Latin. If you play Phrygian over a flamenco style chord progression such as E – F – G you can really hear the Latin nature of the Phrygian mode. Phrygian also leans in a minor direction. Heavy Metal guitarist use this scale over minor chords and it creates an “Egyptian” or “middle east” sound, a very interesting and different flavor.

Mode #4 Lydian: The Lydian mode also relates to the major chord family, but the raised or sharp 4th suggests something a little different. If a chord progression in the key of C goes from C – D7 or D9 and then to G, then the Lydian mode is perfect to play over the D7 or D9. The raised 4th in C Lydian is the same note as the 3rd in a D7 or D9 chord, which is F#. Lydian also works well over diminished 5th and augmented 11th chords. The raised 4th is the same note as the lowered 5th of the diminished 5th chord, which is referred to as the enharmonic equivalent. The raised 4th played an octave higher is an augmented 11th.

Mode #5 Mixolydian: The Mixolydian mode works great over the dominant chord types, such as C7, C9, C11 and C13. It leans in the major chord direction, so it also sounds good over chord progressions using major chords and suspended chords, such as C to Csus2 to Csus4 then back to C.

Mode #6 Aeolian: The Aeolian mode is also known as the natural minor or relative minor of a key. Along with the Dorian mode, it is one of the most commonly used modes for improvising. Aeolian works well over all the minor chords. If your chord progression has mostly minor chords, you can shift between Aeolian and Dorian modes as you improvise, creating endless

expressive possibilities. There are three forms of the minor scale, natural or pure, which is Aeolian mode, harmonic and melodic.

Mode#7 Locrian: The Locrian mode works well over the m7b5 chord. An example of its use would be if a chord progression were in the key of G and it is heading toward its relative minor, which is Em, and it passes through an F#m7b5 to B7 on its way, like this, G – F#m7b5 – B7 – Em.

Fig. 11 shows the major scale with each mode written below the degree of the scale that each one originates on. Above each degree of the scale is the chord type that is created on each degree using a triad (the 1st, 3rd and 5th notes starting with that particular degree of the scale). These chord types happen naturally in every key. These are also called the “diatonic chords” of the key.

Fig. 11

I	II	III	IV	V	VI	VII
C	Dm	Em	F	G7	Am	B dim

Ionian	Dorian	Phrygian	Lydian	Mixolydian	Aeolian	Locrian
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Each mode will work well when played over the same “chord type” that is built on the same degree of the scale that the mode itself is built upon.

Chord Progressions and Scales for the Backing Tracks

The following section has the chord progression for each of the practice tracks on the CD. Before each song you will find suggested scales in the pentatonic modes and seven tone scales in the modes that work well for the song. Play through these scales as you listen to the song so that you can hear how the modes sound in that scenario. You should also play licks that you learned in the lick section.

As I mentioned before, the pentatonics are the workhorse of the lead guitar world. Because they have five notes, they more easily adapt to chord progressions, sort of a universal tool.

Even though the major and minor pentatonic scales are the most popular, the pentatonics can be used in other modes.

As illustrated on the **Master Scale Form** page, anytime you are playing one of the seven tone scale shapes on the fretboard in any mode or key, the corresponding pentatonic shape that comes from that scale directly below can be used. The pentatonic shape has its notes in common with the seven-tone scale shape that it came from.

There are two approaches to improvising leads over chord progressions. One is to play the same mode and scale shape or pentatonic shape over the entire chord progression. This works well with simple progressions such as the 12 bar blues. The second is to change modes and scale shapes, which includes the pentatonics, over each chord, or sets of chords in a chord progression. This is done when the chord progression is more complicated, and the “tonal center” of the group of chords changes from the original key that the progression started in.

A good example of changing modes during a progression is when you move from minor pentatonic to major pentatonic over the 12-bar blues played in a major key.

The first practice track is the **Am7 Groove – Track 18**. As I mentioned before, I play the sixteen licks that you learned in the lick section to this groove, so that you can hear how they can be used. **Am7 Groove – Track 19** is your opportunity to use the licks. I suggest playing the licks as closely as you can to how I played them, and then experiment with your own voicing.

Also, play through the minor pentatonic shapes, as well as the Dorian mode and Aeolian mode that are illustrated on the scale page before the songs chord chart. As you play through the scales, randomly use the lead guitar techniques that you have learned. Just playing the scales in order will sound like a lead. Then incorporate bends, slides and hammer-ons ect. Lick ideas will come to you. Don't be afraid to “rob” parts of the sixteen licks for your own leads.

Chicago Blues in A – Track 20

The “Blues in A” song on CD track 20 is a good opportunity to use both the major and minor pentatonic scales. If a chord progression such as this one uses primarily major chords, you can use both the major and minor pentatonics. If the chord progression is in a minor key and uses primarily minor chords, then the minor pentatonic would be the primary scale to use, the major will not work as well.

Because the chords in this song are also dominant chords, or seventh chords, Mixolydian mode will also work good for improvising.

Jazz in G – Track 21 & 22

The Jazz in G track 21 is a good song to practice the five seven tone scale shapes in the Ionian mode, or Major scale, in the key of “G”. On track 21 I play all five shapes in consecutive order starting with shape 1 on the third fret, making G the root note. I first play through in eighth notes and then with sixteenth notes. This is an excellent way to study and memorize the scale shapes.

Track 22 is your opportunity to improvise with the Ionian mode and also the Lydian and Major pentatonic.

R&B in C – Track 23

With this track we will need to transpose our sixteen licks that we learned into the key of “C”. Dorian mode and Aeolian mode will work as well. This is a classic example of using the Minor Pentatonic, Dorian Mode and Aeolian mode in a song with primarily minor chords in a minor key.

Following this section I have illustrated how to transpose the licks we know from the A minor pentatonic position to the C minor pentatonic position.

First play through the A minor pentatonic scale, then play lick number 1 in A minor. Then do the same for C minor pentatonic and lick number 1 in C minor.

Latin Groove in E – Track 24

This track has been included so that you can experiment with the Phrygian mode and hear its Latin influence. The minor Pentatonic and Aeolian mode works well for this groove also.

Blues in G – Track 25

This track is straightforward blues. You will need to transpose your licks and scales into the key of G, using the same principles that we used when we transposed into C for the R&B groove.

Remember that for dominant seven chords in a 12-bar blues progression like this you can utilize the Mixolydian mode as well as the major and minor pentatonics.

Funk in A – Track 26

This track will use the scales and modes as track 20 Blues in A. Because the song is faster, it offers a different scenario to play your licks in. All of the sixteen licks that you have learned will work well with this song.

Acoustic in C – Track 27

This track will offer you an opportunity to play different scales over parts of the chord progression.

Mixolydian mode sounds good over suspended chords, giving an interesting sound for a rock progression such as this one. In the beginning section you can experiment with the Mixolydian mode over the Csus2 and Csus4 chords.

Also use the major pentatonic and Ionian mode. You can hear the Ionian mode automatically become minor when the chord progression goes to the relative minor chord for the key of C, which is Am.

This happens because the root tone for the scale shapes will be found by making the number 1 in the seven-tone shape land on the C note. In that same position the number 6 is landing on the A note, which is the Aeolian mode.

12 Bar in E – Track 28

Blues in E is very fun to improvise over because you can use the second minor pentatonic scale shape in first position. This lends itself to hammer-ons and pull-offs to the open string notes to give that “Stevie Ray” feel.

I have also written out a tab for the rhythm guitar part. This rhythm is played on the track and it should be familiar to you as the classic style for the E blues.

Try also incorporating the Ionian mode and Mixolydian mode in “E” with this track.

Transposing Lick #1 from A Minor Pentatonic to C Minor Pentatonic

Lick #1 in A Minor

Guitar

Guitar

T
A
B

Lick #1 in C Minor

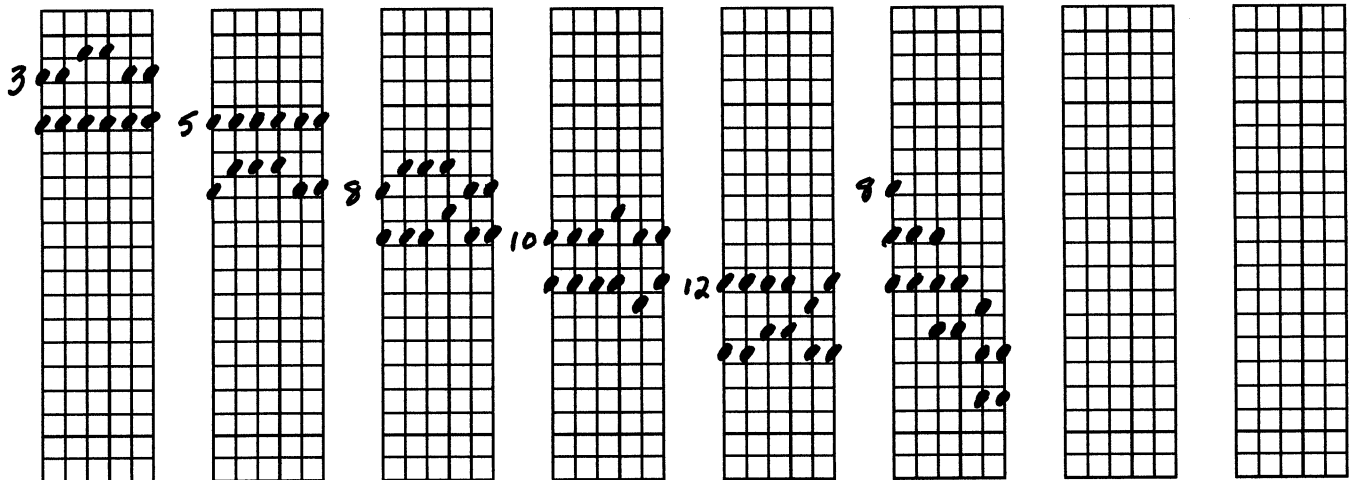
Gtr.

Gtr.

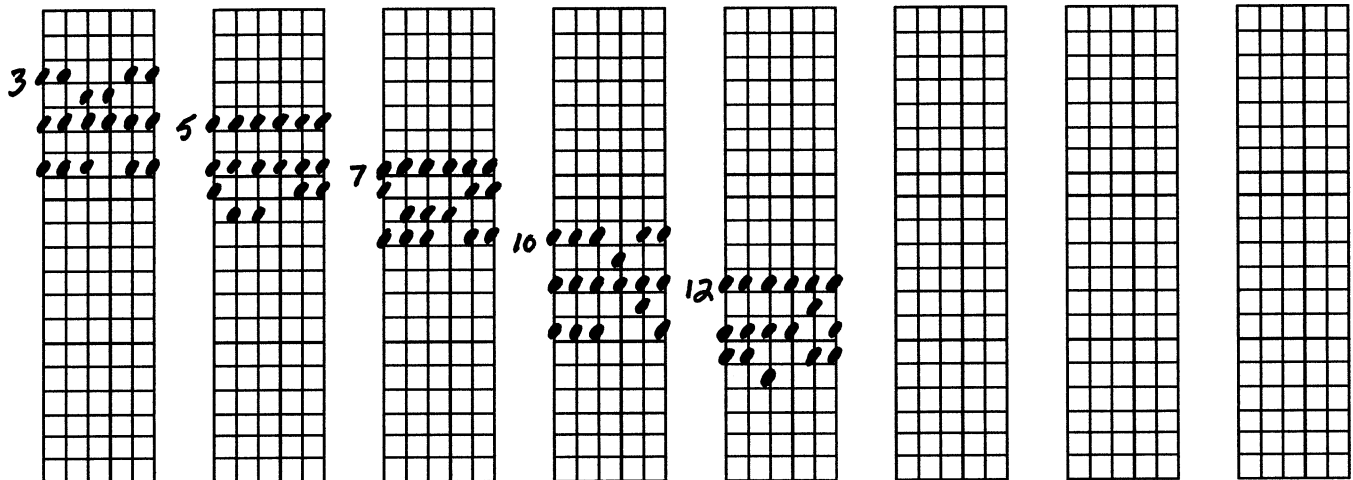
A Minor Pentatonic

C Minor Pentatonic

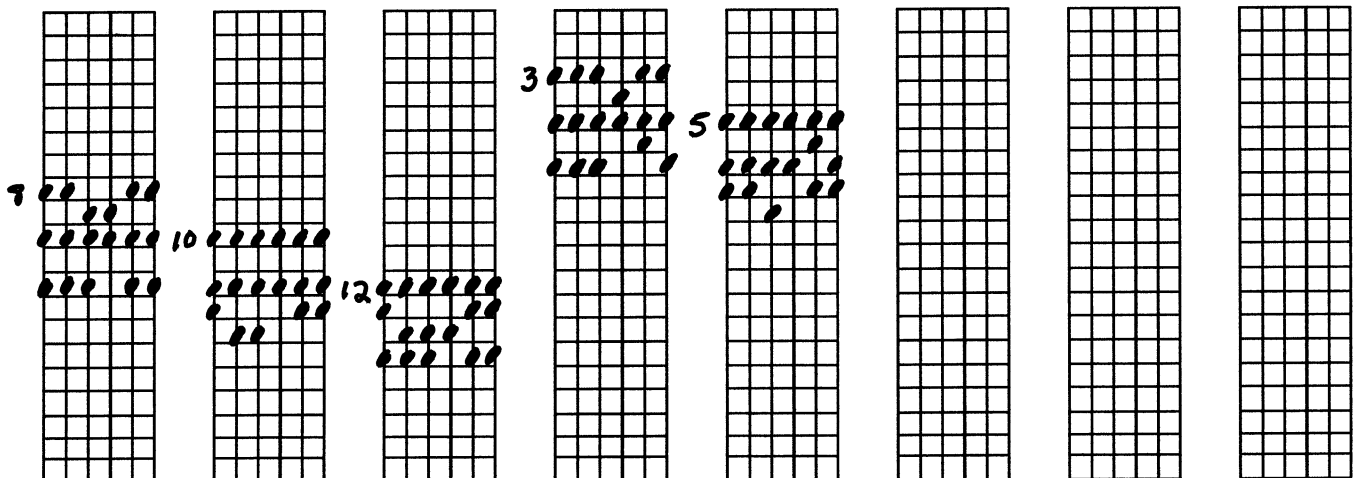
MINOR PENTATONIC



DORIAN MODE



AEOLIAN MODE



AM7 GROOVE

A AM7 EM7 FMA7 DM7 EM7

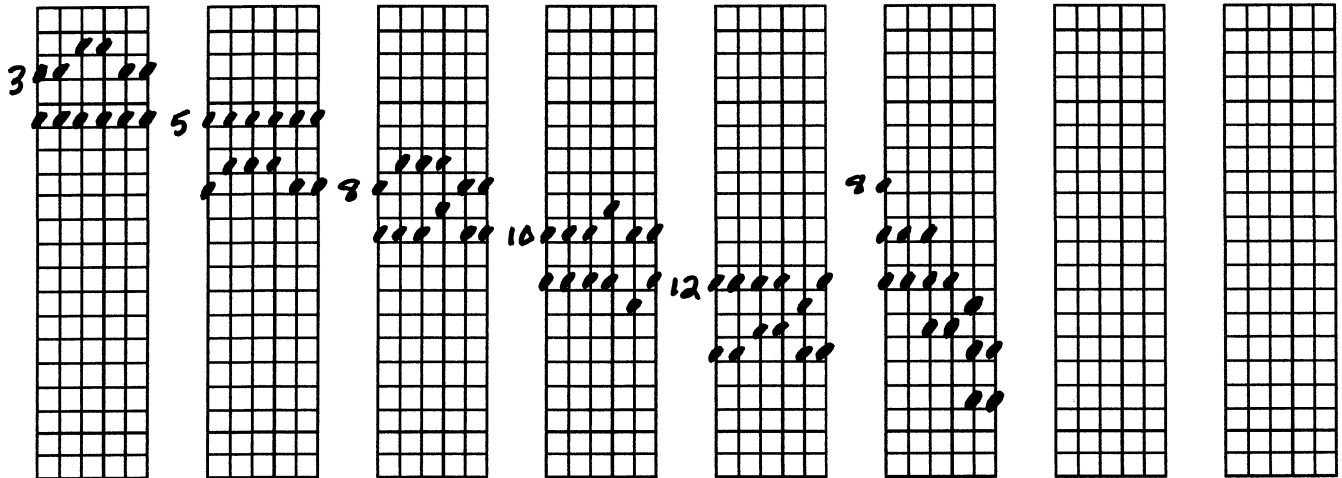
5 8 D9 AM7

9 D9 B7 E9

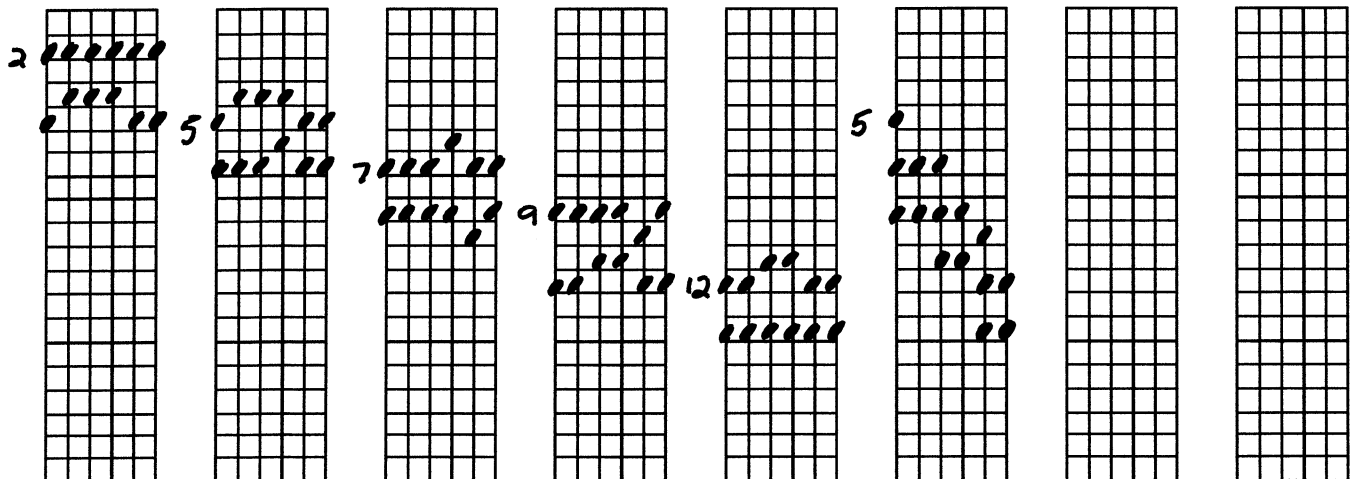
END AM7 EM7 FMA7 DM7 EM7

13

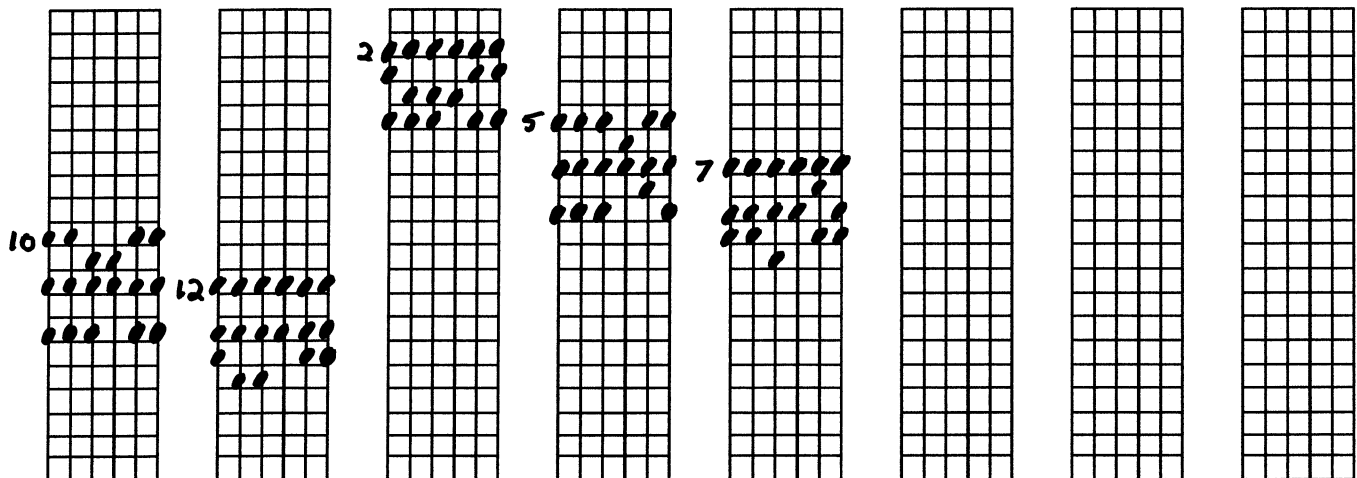
MINOR PENTATONIC



MAJOR PENTATONIC



MIXOLYDIAN MODE



CHICAGO BLUES IN A

Chord progression for Chicago Blues in A:

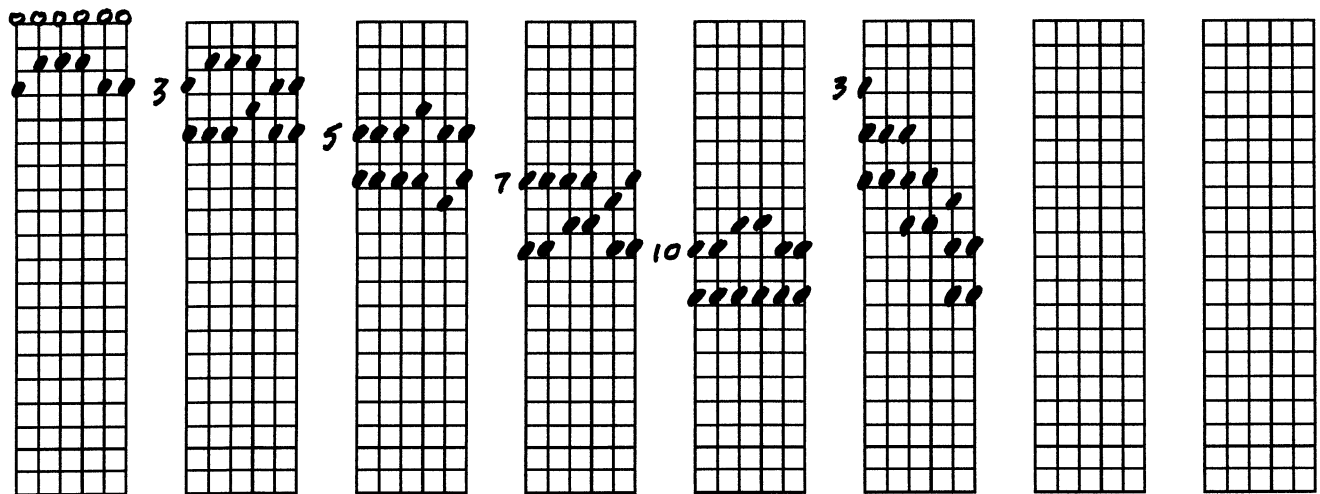
Measures 1-5: E⁹ E^b₉ D⁹ A⁷ E⁹ A⁷

Measures 6-11: D⁹ A⁷

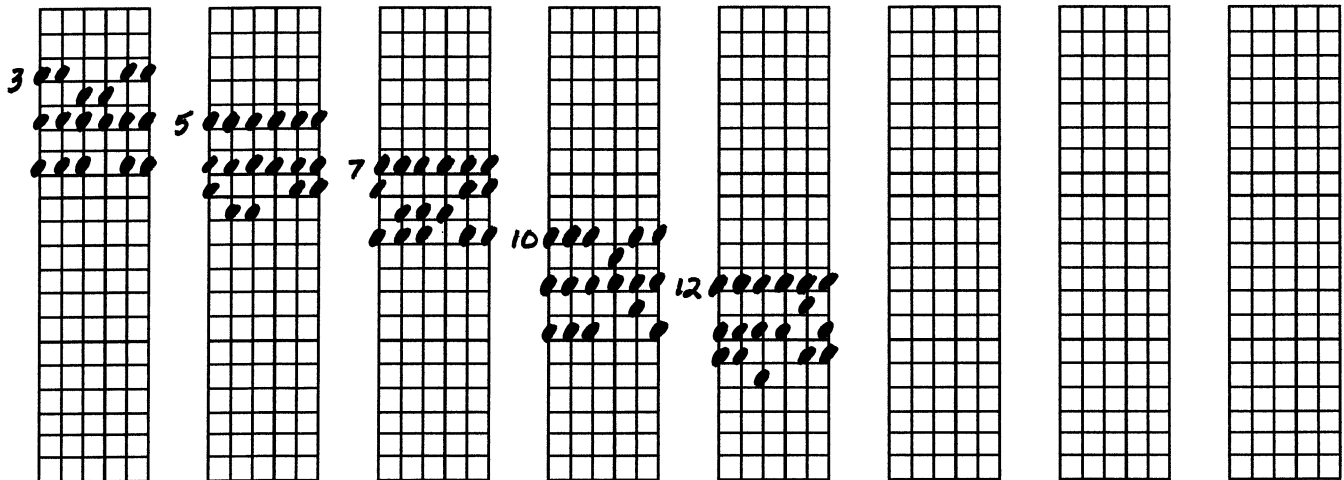
Measures 12-16: E⁹ D⁹ A⁷ E⁹

Measures 17-20: E⁹ D⁹ A⁷ E⁹ A⁷

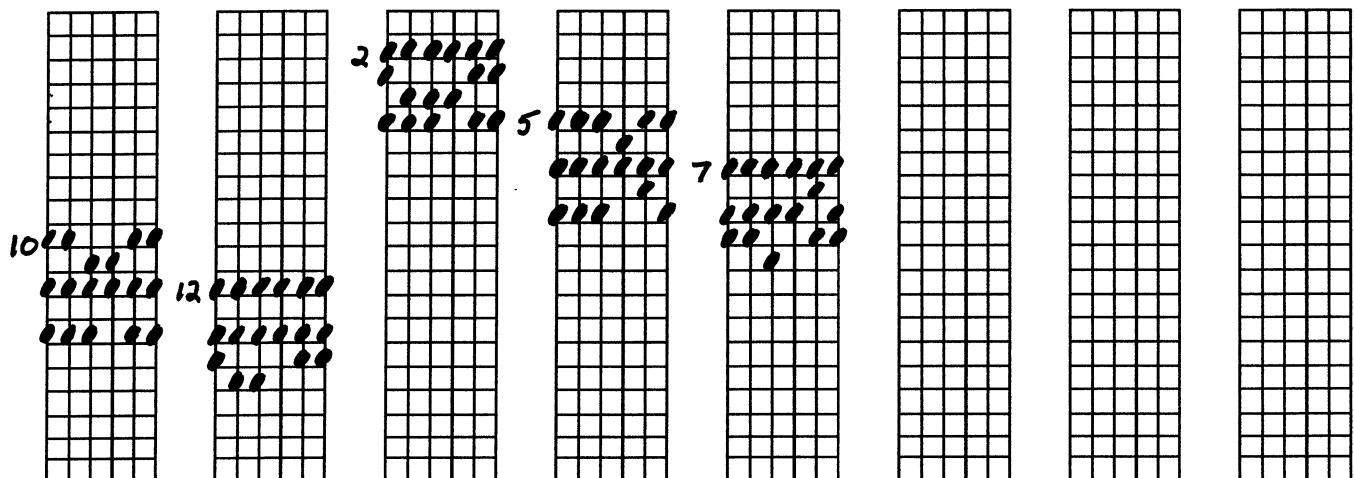
MAJOR PENTATONIC



IONIAN MODE



LYDIAN MODE



JAZZ IN G

INTRO AM7



AM7

D9



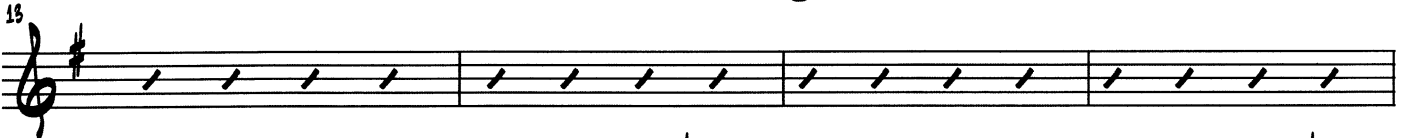
Bm7

Ebm7



Cmaj7

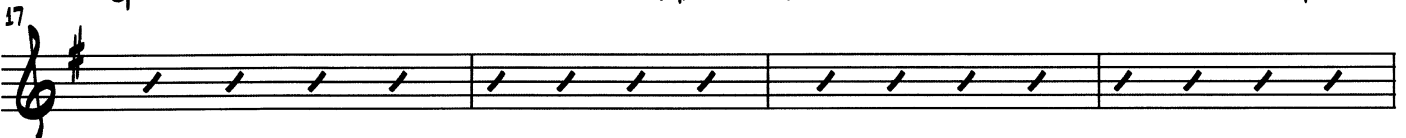
D9



Gmaj7

F#maj7 Fmaj7

F#maj7



Gmaj7

F#maj7 Fmaj7

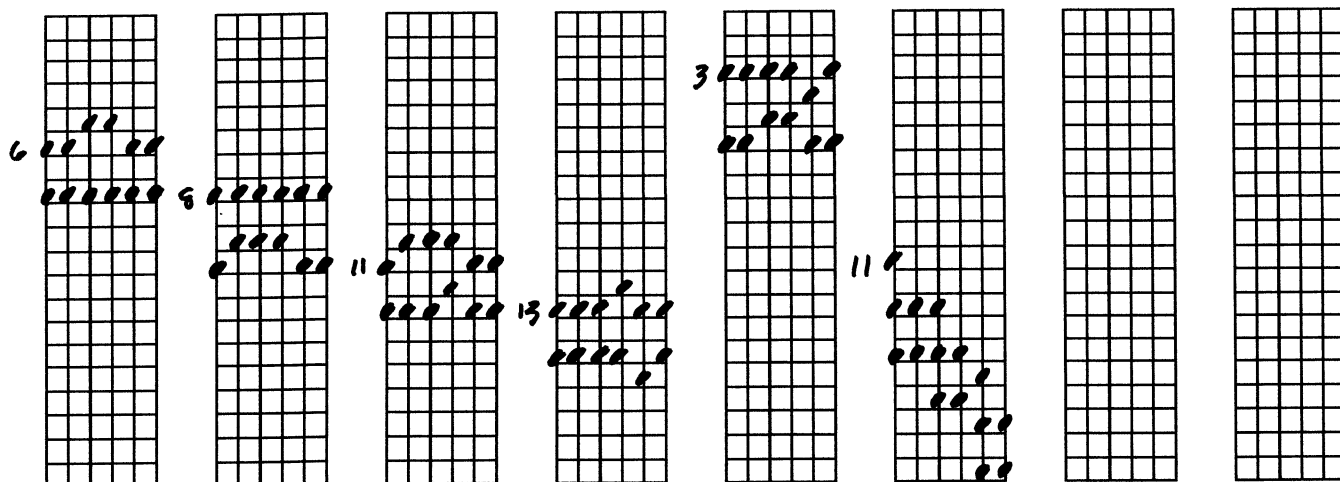
F#maj7



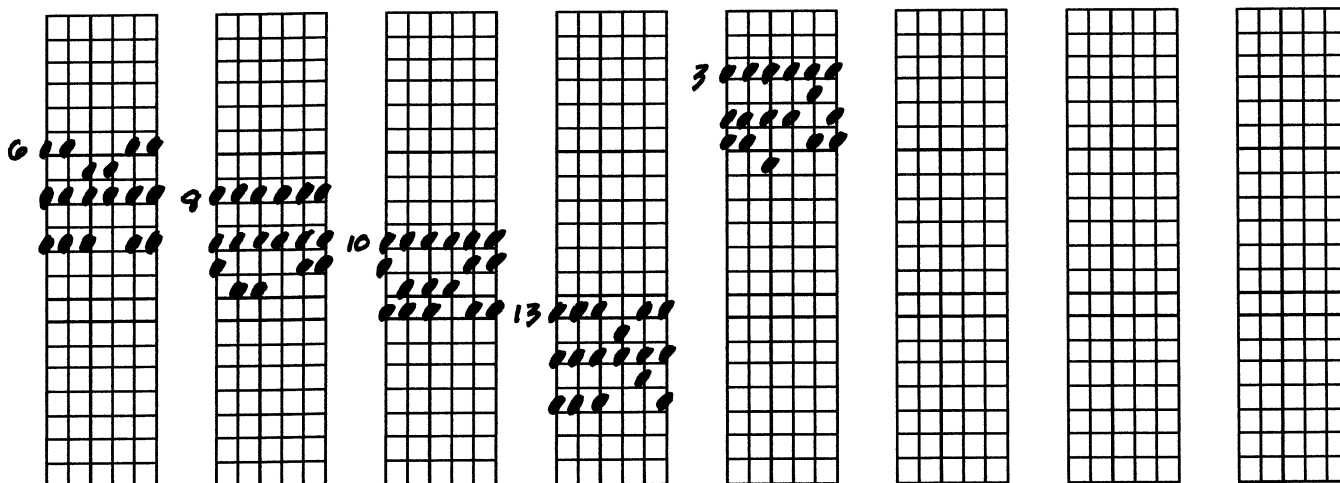
ENDING AM7



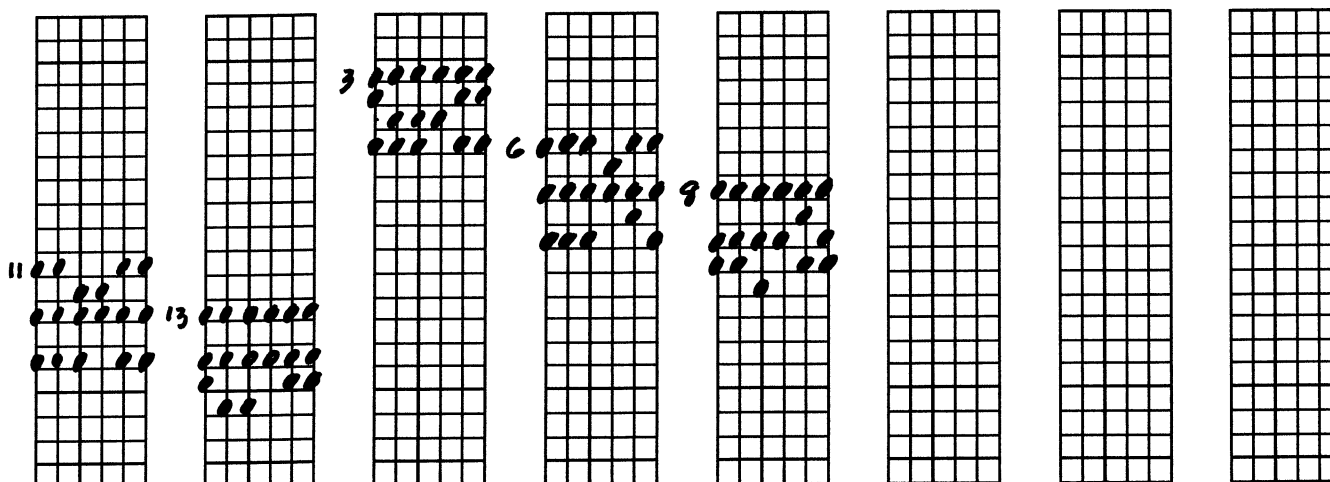
MINOR PENTATONIC



DORIAN MODE



AEOLIAN MODE



R&B IN C

Handwritten musical notation for "R&B IN C" in common time (C). The notation consists of five staves, each with six measures. The notes are represented by diagonal slashes. Chord symbols are written above the staves.

Staff 1:

- Measures 1-6: C^{M7} INTRO, F⁷, C^{M7}, F⁷, A^{b7}, G⁷

Staff 2:

- Measures 1-6: C^{M7}, C^{M7}, A^{bMA57}, F^{M7}, G⁷
- Measure 3 contains a repeat sign and the letter "A".

Staff 3:

- Measures 1-6: C^{M7}, A^{bMA57}, D^{M7} G^{7(b9)}, C^{M7}, F^{M7}, B^{b7}
- Measure 5 contains a repeat sign and the letter "B".

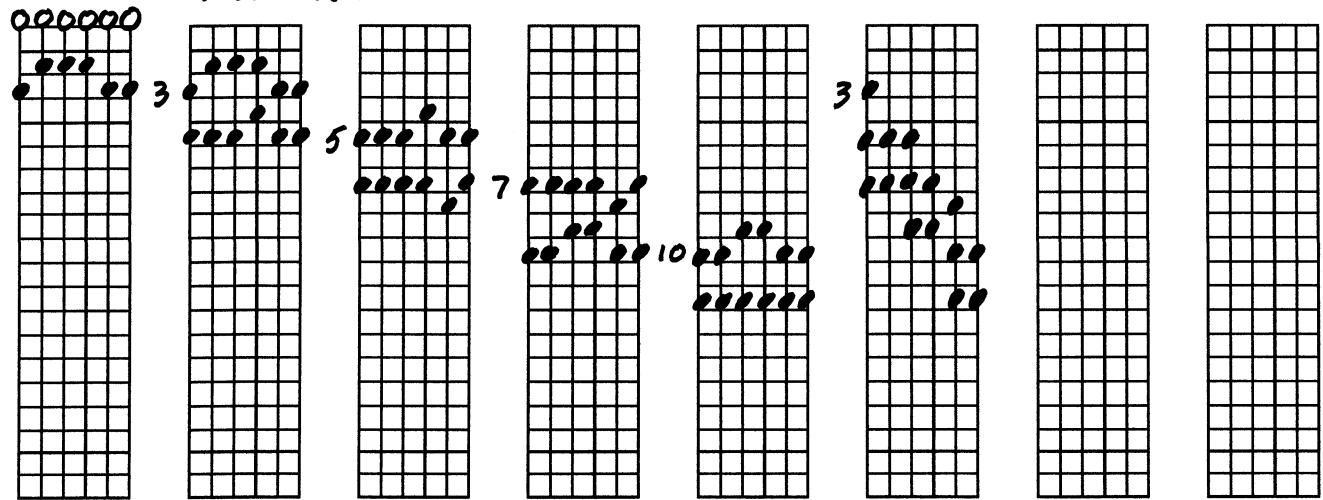
Staff 4:

- Measures 1-6: E^{bMA57}, A^{bMA57}, D^{M7(b5)}, G^{7(b9)}, C^{M7}

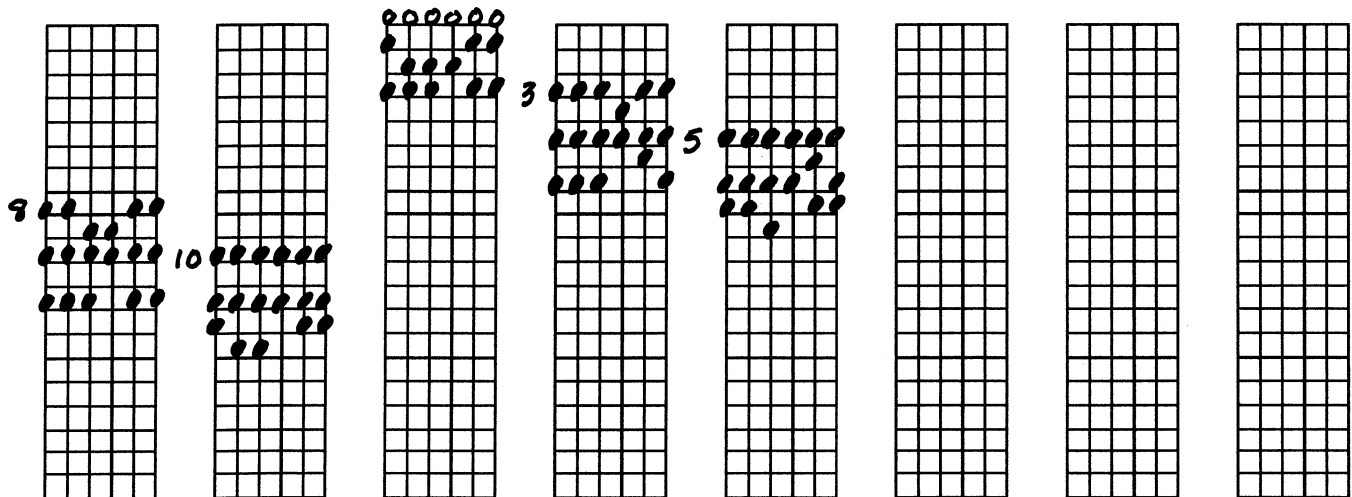
Staff 5:

- Measures 1-6: C^{M7} ENDING, F⁷, A^{b7}, G⁷, C^{M7}

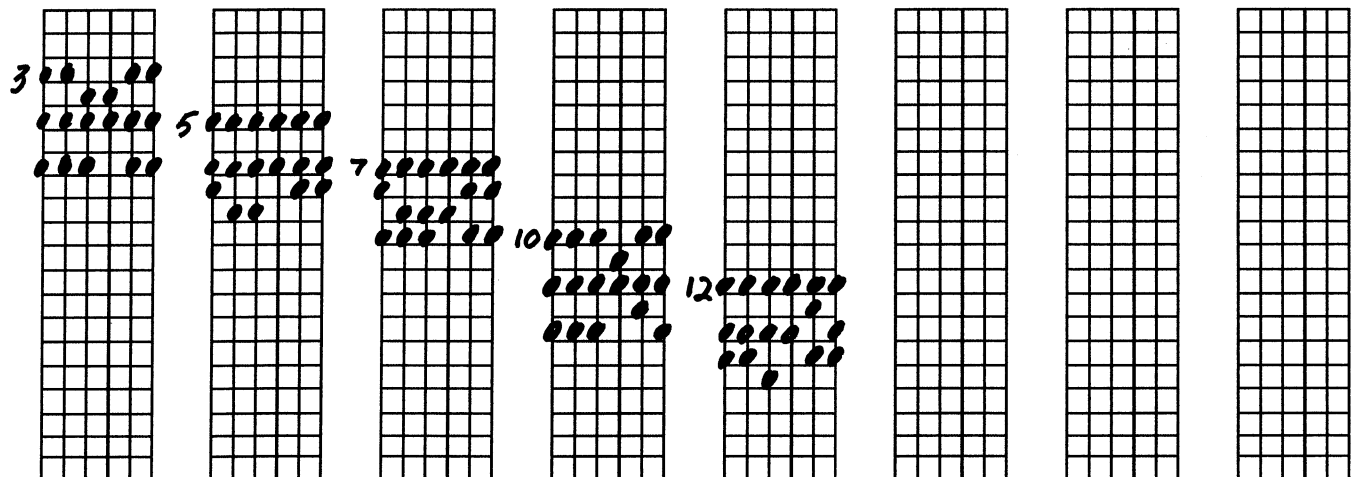
MINOR PENTATONIC



PHRYGIAN MODE



AEOLIAN MODE



LATIN IN E

INTRO E F#sus4/C E F#sus4/C A E

9 F#sus4/C E G#sus4/D F#sus4/C E

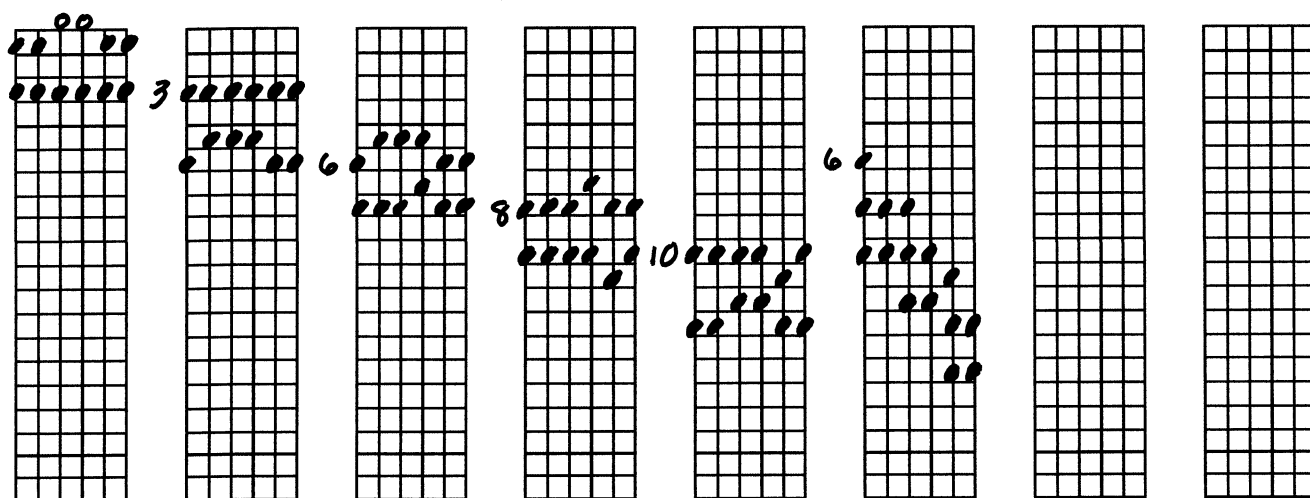
17 F#sus4/C E G#sus4/D F#sus4/C E

25 B E F#sus4/C G#sus4/D F#sus4/C

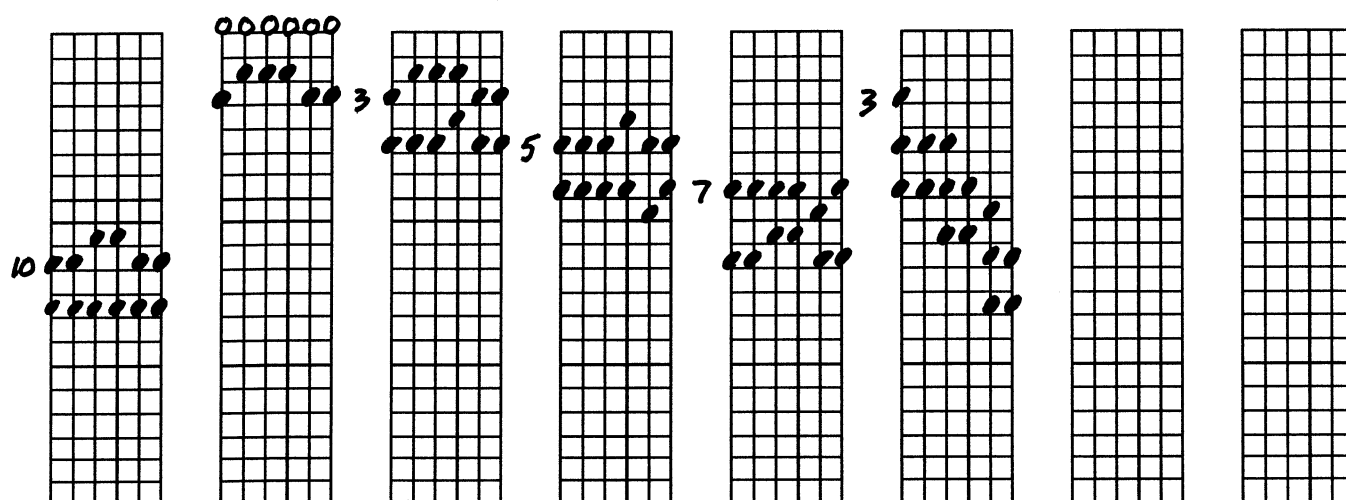
ENDING E E G#sus4/D F#sus4/C E

33

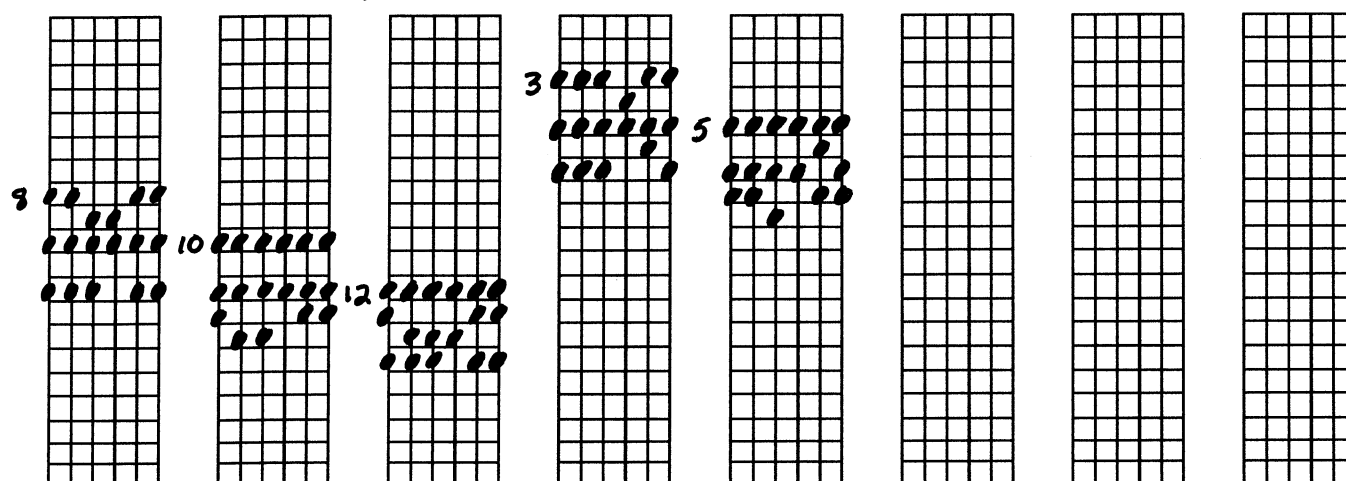
MINOR PENTATONIC



MAJOR PENTATONIC



MIXOLYDIAN MODE



BLUES IN G

G7 **C9** **G7** **E7** **A7** **D9**

INTRO

G7 **C9** **G7**

C9 **G7**

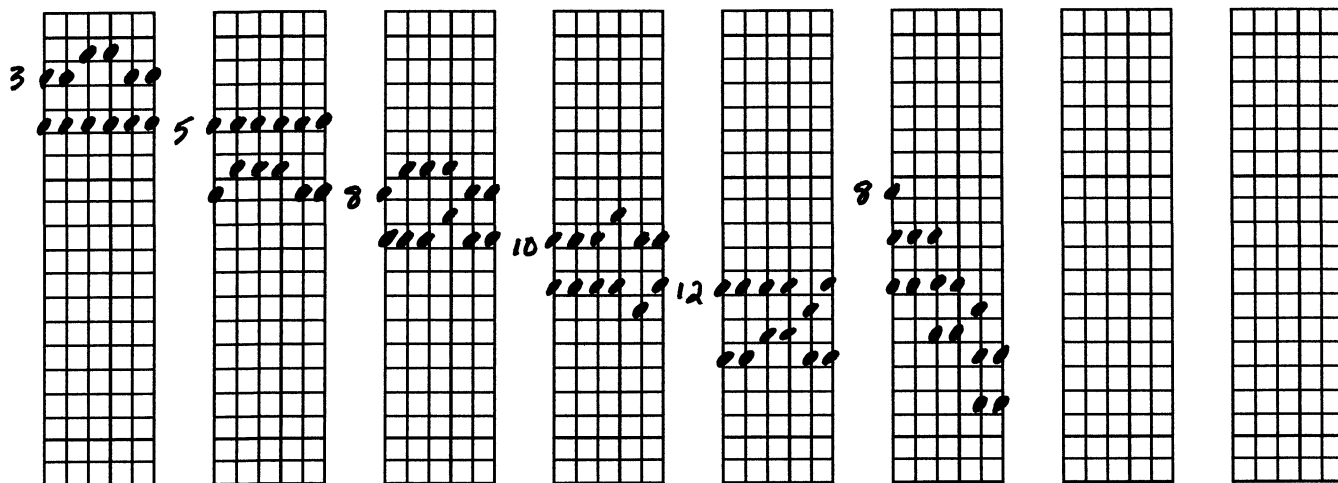
D9 **C9** **G7** **D9**

G7 **E7** **E^b9** **D9** **G7** **C9** **G7** **D9**

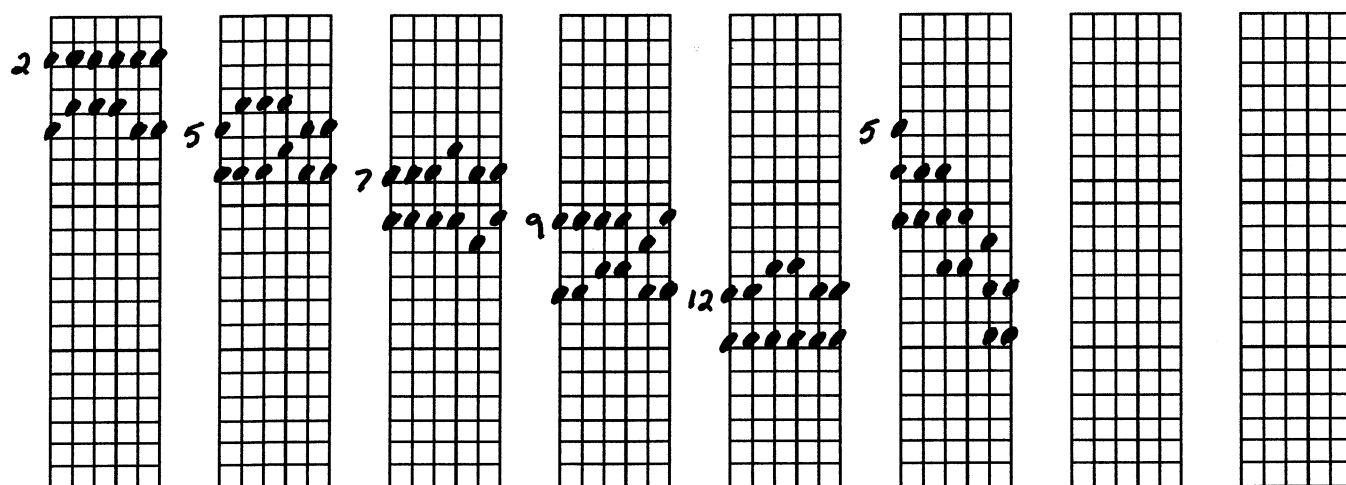
ENDING

G7

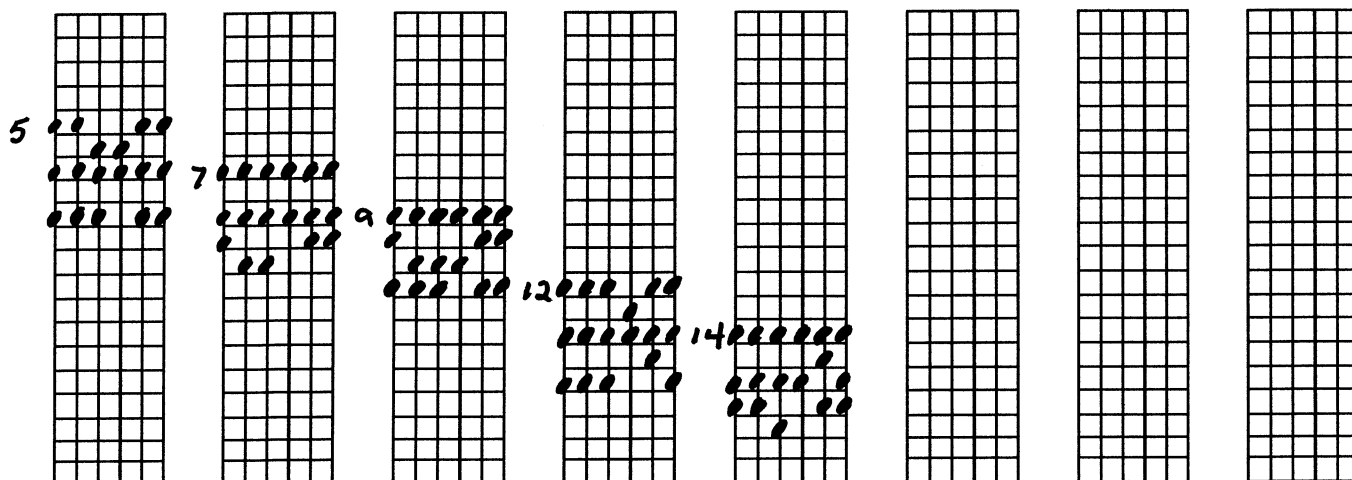
MINOR PENTATONIC



MAJOR PENTATONIC



IONIAN MODE



FUNK IN A

Handwritten musical score for "FUNK IN A". The score is written in treble clef with a key signature of three sharps (F#, C#, G#) and a common time signature (C). The music consists of five staves, each containing four measures of rhythmic notation (diagonal slashes). Chord symbols are written above the staves, and measure numbers are indicated on the left.

Staff 1: Measure 1 is marked with "A7" and "INTRO". Measure 4 contains the notes G, G#, and A.

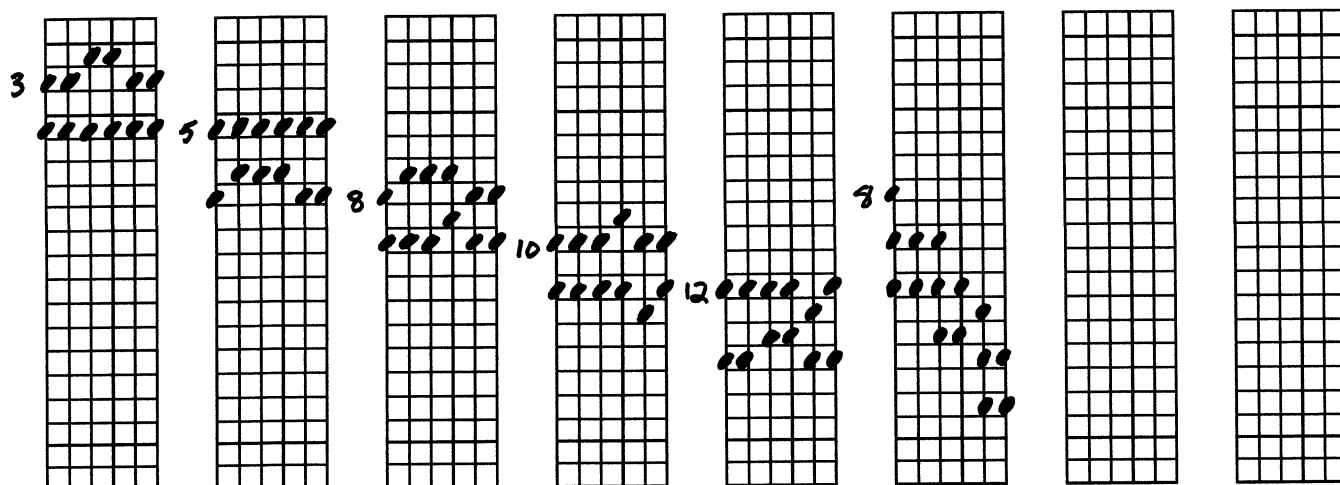
Staff 2: Measure 1 is marked with "A7". Measure 2 is marked with "D9". Measure 3 is marked with "A7".

Staff 3: Measure 1 is marked with "D9". Measure 3 is marked with "A7".

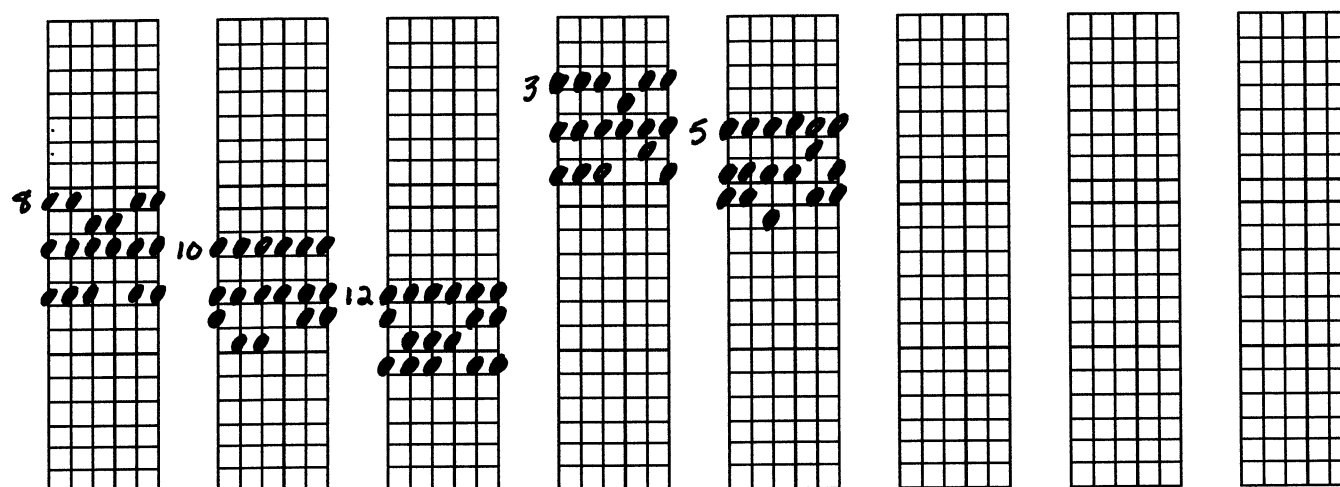
Staff 4: Measure 1 is marked with "E9". Measure 2 is marked with "D9". Measure 3 is marked with "A7". Measure 4 is marked with "E9".

Staff 5: Measure 1 is marked with "E9" and "ENDING". Measure 3 is marked with "A7". Measure 4 contains the notes G, G#, and A.

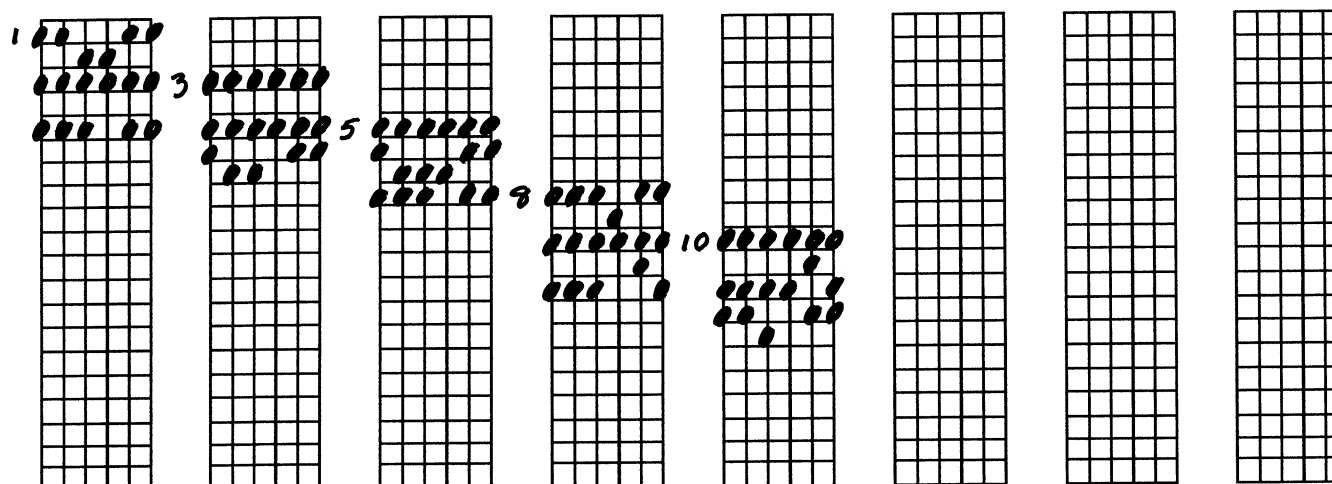
MAJOR PENTATONIC



IONIAN MODE



MIXOLYDIAN MODE



ACOUSTIC ROCK IN C

Handwritten musical notation for guitar, featuring chords and a melodic line. The notation is organized into four systems, each with a staff and a corresponding chord progression.

System 1: Chords: C, Csus2, Csus4, C, Am. Melody: A series of eighth notes.

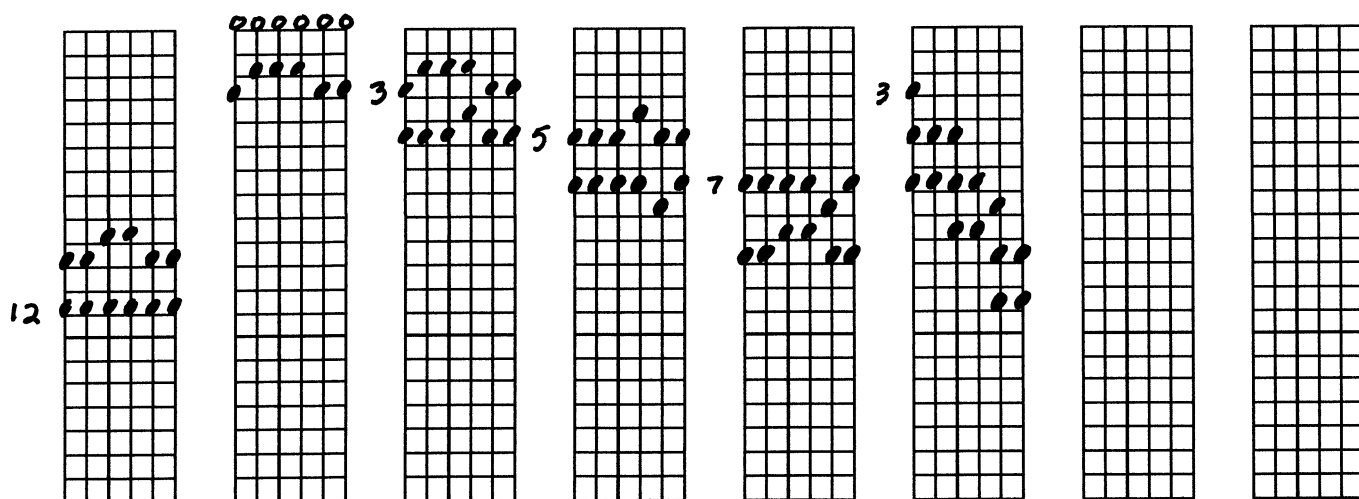
System 2: Chords: Fmaj7, G, C, Csus2, Csus4, C. Melody: A series of eighth notes.

System 3: Chords: C, Csus2, Csus4, C, Am, G. Melody: A series of eighth notes.

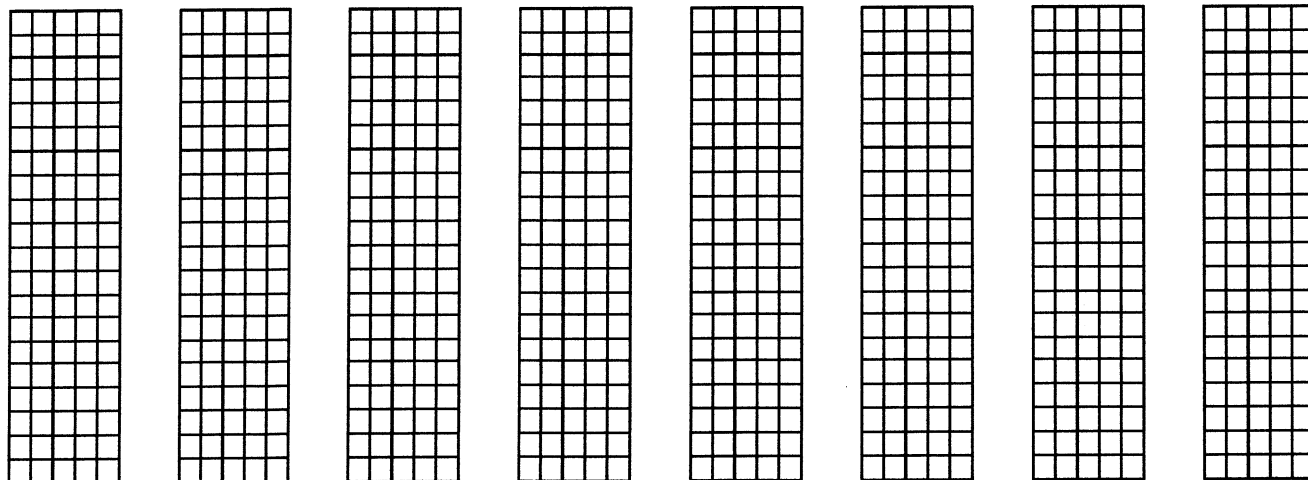
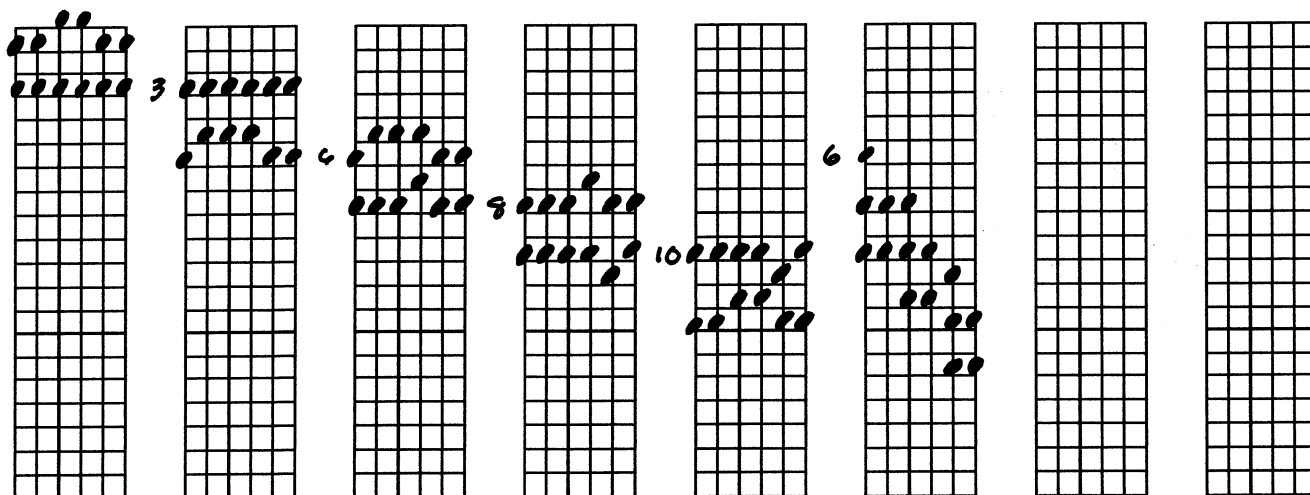
System 4: Chords: Am, G, Am, G. Melody: A series of eighth notes.

System 5: Chords: C, Bb, F, C. Melody: A series of eighth notes. The word "ENDING" is written below the staff.

MINOR PENTATONIC



MAJOR PENTATONIC



12 Bar In E

The image shows a page of guitar tablature for the song "I Wanna Dance with Somebody" by Whitney Houston. The page contains six systems of music, each with a guitar staff and a bass staff. The systems are labeled with chords: E, A, E, B7, and E. The tablature includes fret numbers, bar lines, and various musical notations like triplets and bends. The bass staff is labeled with "T", "A", and "B" at the beginning of the first system.